

Sophie Purewal

Senior Product Designer • Design Systems • AI Prototyping

sophiepurewal.github.io • linkedin.com/in/sophiepurewal • sophiepurewaldesign@gmail.com • London, UK

Summary

Senior Product Designer specialising in accessible digital products and scalable design systems for complex, regulated services. Combines strong visual design craft, accessibility, product thinking and close collaboration with engineering. Recent design-system work includes reusable Figma components supporting 21,000+ tracked insertions across header, status, feedback, layout and form patterns over 12 months, with 15 Core Components progressed through design and engineering governance into a shared library. Experienced taking work from early journeys and component definition through documentation, handoff, UAT and production-ready UI.

Areas of Expertise

Design Systems & Product Craft: Design System Strategy | Component & Pattern Design | Figma Library Management | Design System Governance | Governed Releases | Adoption Measurement & Figma Analytics | Interaction & Visual Design | Accessible Product UI | Accessibility & WCAG | Responsive Design | AI-Assisted Prototyping | Developer Handoff | Design QA & UAT

Collaboration & Leadership: Systems Thinking | Product Thinking | End-to-End Ownership | Product & Engineering Collaboration | Stakeholder Facilitation | Clear Written Communication | Constructive Feedback | Cross-Team Collaboration | Working Autonomously | Adaptability | Continuous Improvement

Key Achievements

- **End-to-End Product Design:** Led discovery-to-delivery UX and UI design for the first phase of the ePlacements platform, defining MVP functionality through research, personas, user flows, responsive prototypes, usability testing, preference testing and A/B testing.
- **Design-System Adoption:** Built and modernised reusable Figma components supporting **21,000+ tracked insertions** across product teams, reducing duplicate design effort and enabling more consistent interfaces at scale.
- **Scalable Product Patterns:** Delivered shared status, feedback and layout components with **12,300+ insertions**, alongside accessible form components with **6,300+ insertions** across complex customer journeys.
- **Component Governance & Leadership:** Progressed **15 Core Components** through design and engineering governance into the shared Figma library, while strengthening team capability through Figma training for **five designers** and **seven months of graduate mentoring**.

Career

Senior UI Designer • Aegon UK • Aug 2022 – Present • London, UK

- Translated complex pension contribution requirements into a clearer public-facing calculator experience, collaborating with stakeholders and delivery teams within a regulated environment.

- Owned Core Component redesigns from initial problem definition through peer and engineering review, component documentation and shared-library release, reducing duplicate UI effort and improving cross-team consistency.
- Progressed 15 redesigned Core Components through design and engineering governance into the shared Figma library, strengthening the quality and reliability of approved reusable patterns.
- Strengthened design capability across the wider team by mentoring five designers through an internal Figma Fundamentals course and supporting a graduate designer over seven months through Figma practice, creative brainstorming and UAT.

Founder & Director • Sophie Purewal Design • Jul 2017 – Aug 2022 • London, UK

- Founded and operated an independent design studio delivering product, UX, UI, brand, responsive web and app design for clients.
- Delivered end-to-end product design from discovery and research through to wireframes, high-fidelity interfaces, prototypes, design systems and developer handoff.

Selected client engagement: VLE ePlacements • UX & UI Designer • Jun 2018 – Oct 2018

- Led discovery-to-delivery UX and UI design for the first phase of a work-placement platform supporting learning providers, students and employers.
- Defined core product flows and MVP functionality through collaborative research, personas, user flows, low-to-high fidelity wireframes, prototype testing, preference testing and A/B testing.
- Delivered responsive UI across mobile, tablet and desktop, including visual concepts, style guidance, grids, typography, iconography, interactive prototypes and final assets for handoff.
- Strengthened client design maturity through clearer design processes, documented decisions, collaboration tools and improved handoff practices.

UI Design Mentor • Contract client: CareerFoundry • Aug 2017 – Aug 2022 • London, UK

- Mentored students and UX professionals transitioning into UI and Product Design careers through portfolio reviews, structured feedback and design coaching.
- Improved student outcomes through guidance on visual hierarchy, layout, typography, colour, usability, accessibility and prototype quality.
- Edited and rewrote UI for UX course materials, increasing clarity and alignment with current design practice.

Selected Product Innovation

ChartStudio, an AI-Assisted Figma Plugin • May 2026 – Present • Active Development

- Identified a recurring workflow gap for designers creating consistent data visualisations in Figma, defined and prototyped an AI-assisted plugin supporting responsive bar, line and doughnut charts.
- Defined the product concept, UX, feature requirements, configuration model and visual design system independently.
- Used OpenAI Codex and AI-assisted development workflows to prototype functioning plugin capability, demonstrating practical experience bridging product design and software development.

Certifications & Memberships

AI Prototyping Camp • Designlab

Certification in Graphic Design • Shillington

Graphic Design Short Course • UAL

BA (Hons) Ancient History and Archaeology • University of Liverpool

Member • Women in Banking and Finance (WIBF)